ABC of CYBER

Incident Response Plan Template

Phased IR playbook with roles and escalation

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[TEMPLATE -- Customise roles, contacts, and playbook to match your organisation structure.]

1. INCIDENT RESPONSE TEAM ROLES

Role	Name	Primary Contact	Alternate
Incident Commander	[Name]	[Phone / Email]	[Phone / Email]
Technical Lead	[Name]	[Phone / Email]	[Phone / Email]
Communications Lead	[Name]	[Phone / Email]	[Phone / Email]
Legal Counsel	[Name]	[Phone / Email]	[Phone / Email]
Forensics Lead	[Name]	[Phone / Email]	[Phone / Email]
Business Liaison	[Name]	[Phone / Email]	[Phone / Email]

2. ESCALATION TREE

Level 1 -- SOC Analyst / Help Desk (Triage & Initial Response)
>> (if critical / unable to contain)
Level 2 -- Incident Commander / Security Engineer (Coordinated Response)
>> (if legal/comms/business impact)
Level 3 -- CISO / VP Engineering / Legal (Strategy, Disclosure, Crisis Mgmt)
>> (if board-level / regulatory)
Level 4 -- CEO / Board of Directors (Shareholder comms, external disclosure)

3. KEY CONTACTS

Contact	Role	Phone	Email
[Name]	CISO	[Number]	[Email]
[Name]	IT Director	[Number]	[Email]
[Name]	Legal Counsel	[Number]	[Email]
[Name]	PR / Comms	[Number]	[Email]
[Name]	HR Lead	[Number]	[Email]
[Name]	External Forensics	[Number]	[Email]
Police (Cyber)	Local	101 (non-emergency)	actionfraud.police.uk
NCSC	UK National	0300 123 2040	incidents@ncsc.gov.uk

4. INCIDENT RESPONSE PHASES

Example only, not legal advice. Have a qualified lawyer check it suits your circumstances and meets your local laws (including signing and witnessing rules) before using it.

PHASE 1 -- PREPARATION

* Maintain and test IRP annually
* Conduct tabletop exercises quarterly
* Deploy endpoint detection & response (EDR)
* Keep forensic toolkits updated
* Establish comms channels (Signal, Slack, phone tree)

PHASE 2 -- IDENTIFICATION & TRIAGE

* Confirm alert and classify severity (Low / Med / High / Critical)
* Collect initial evidence: logs, screenshots, memory capture
* Assign IR Commander
* Determine scope: systems, users, data affected
* Notify stakeholders per escalation policy

PHASE 3 -- CONTAINMENT

* Short-term: isolate affected systems (network ACL, disconnect)
* Long-term: apply hotfix, rotate credentials, block IOCs
* Preserve forensic evidence before remediation
* Document all actions with timestamps

PHASE 4 -- ERADICATION

* Remove malware / backdoors / persistence mechanisms
* Patch vulnerabilities exploited
* Restore clean systems from verified backups
* Verify no indicators of compromise remain

PHASE 5 -- RECOVERY

* Bring systems back online in a staged fashion
* Monitor for re-infection or lingering IOCs
* Communicate restoration timeline to stakeholders
* Validate controls are effective

PHASE 6 -- LESSONS LEARNED

* Conduct post-incident review within 5 business days
* Update IRP, playbooks, and detection rules
* Document root cause, gaps, and improvement items
* Share findings with relevant teams

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